

What Yonkers Residents Complain About

The top 10 grievances in public comments on the City of Yonkers' official
Facebook and Instagram accounts

Period analysed	Apr 2025 – Aug 2026
Comments collected	4,944
Of which substantive	3,394 (excludes emoji-only and tag-only replies)
Complaints identified	584 (17.2% of substantive)
Sources	facebook.com/cityofyonkers · instagram.com/cityofyonkers
Prepared	August 08, 2026

How this was built

Public comments were collected from the City of Yonkers' official Facebook page and Instagram account covering Apr 2025 – Aug 2026. Every comment was screened for grievance language — complaint markers such as demands to fix something, reports of neglect, questions about why a problem persists, or explicit expressions of frustration. Comments that were purely congratulatory, informational, or off-topic were excluded from the counts.

4,944 comments were collected. A large share of any city page's replies are emoji, tags and one-word reactions, which express no grievance either way, so the **3,394** comments carrying actual prose form the base for every rate in this report. Of those, **584 (17.2%)** registered as complaints and were sorted into civic categories using a weighted keyword classifier. A single comment can touch more than one issue; it is counted once under its dominant theme, with secondary themes tracked separately under “mentions.”

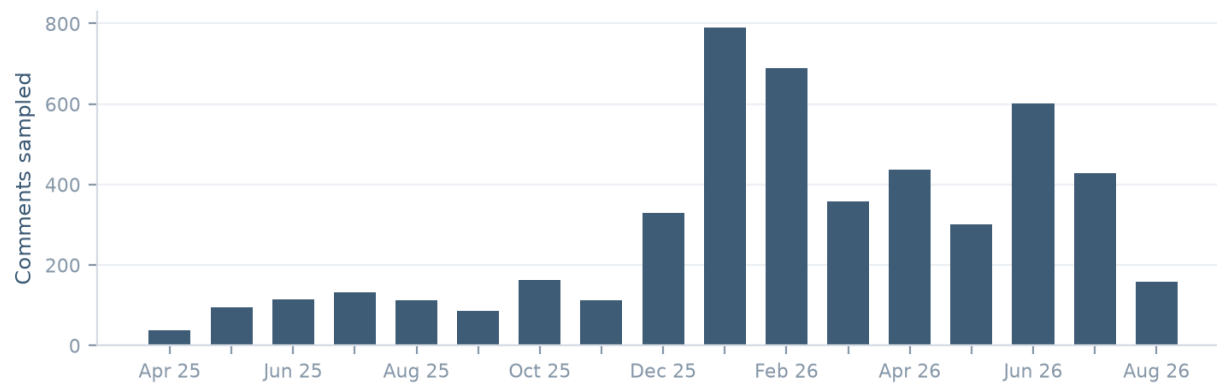
What the numbers do and don't represent

These are the complaints residents chose to post publicly on the city's own channels. They are a strong signal of what frustrates the engaged public, but they are not a representative survey of all Yonkers residents. Comment volume is also shaped by what the city posts about and by moderation. Read the ranking as *what dominates the public conversation*, not as a measured incidence of each problem across the city.

Collection notes

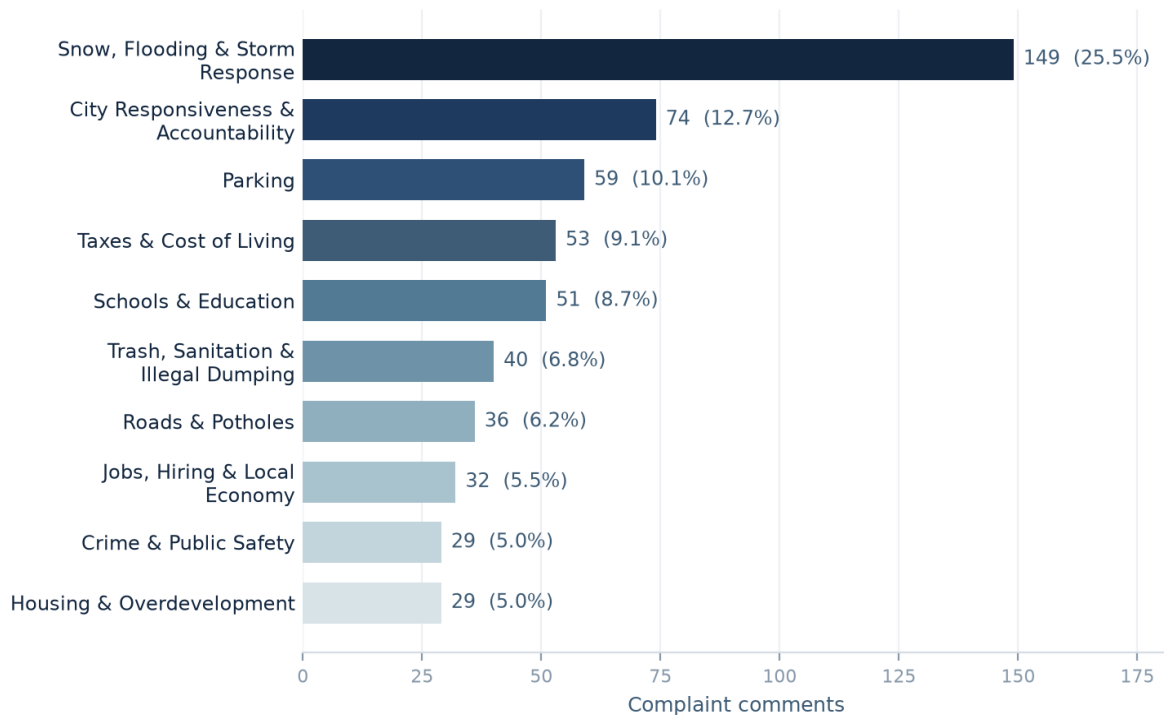
- Coverage is the trailing period the scrapers could reach, not ten years: Facebook posts from November 2025 to August 2026 (566 posts) and Instagram posts from April 2025 to August 2026 (400 posts). Facebook paginates backwards from the newest post, so reaching earlier years costs progressively more scraping credit; the budget was spent on comment depth instead of post history.
- Facebook comments were pulled from the 40 most-commented posts in the window, up to 60 comments each. Heavily discussed posts are therefore over-represented on purpose - that is where grievances collect - so these shares describe the complaint conversation, not the average post.
- Instagram comments are those returned alongside each post, roughly nine per post across all 400 posts, so Instagram contributes a broader but shallower slice than Facebook.
- The window contains two winters and a heavy snow-response period. Seasonal issues are correspondingly prominent; a summer-weighted window would rank them lower.
- Emoji-only, tag-only and one-word reactions are counted in the total collected but excluded from the base used for the complaint rate, since they express no grievance either way.
- Comments posted by official city accounts are excluded, as the scrapers surface them alongside residents' replies.
- A category can rank low simply because the city rarely posted about it. Traffic and reckless driving finish near the bottom here, which is out of step with how residents usually rank that issue; it reflects the absence of traffic-themed posts in this window rather than an absence of concern. Treat the ranking as a measure of the conversation the city's own posts invited.

Comments sampled by month



The top 10 complaints

Snow, Flooding & Storm Response is the single largest source of complaints, accounting for 25.5% of every grievance posted. The three leading themes — Snow, Flooding & Storm Response, City Responsiveness & Accountability, Parking — together make up 48% of all complaints, meaning most of what residents raise on the city's channels concentrates in a handful of recurring issues.

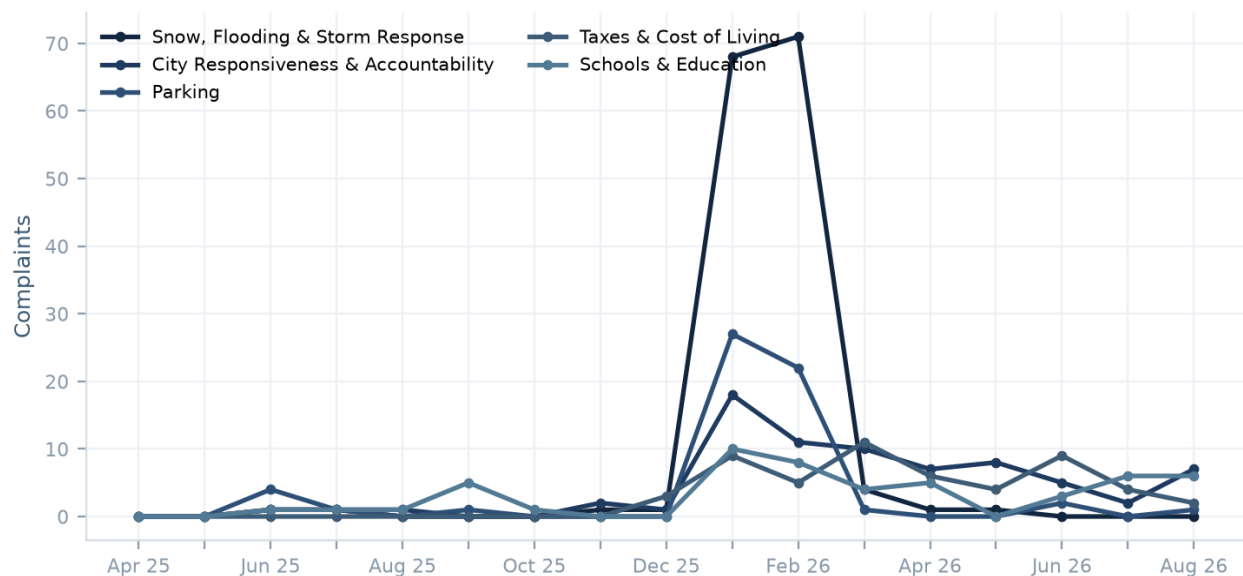


#	Complaint category	Comments	Share	Avg. likes
1	Snow, Flooding & Storm Response	149	25.5%	4.0
2	City Responsiveness & Accountability	74	12.7%	2.6
3	Parking	59	10.1%	3.8
4	Taxes & Cost of Living	53	9.1%	6.1
5	Schools & Education	51	8.7%	3.1
6	Trash, Sanitation & Illegal Dumping	40	6.8%	1.6
7	Roads & Potholes	36	6.2%	3.8
8	Jobs, Hiring & Local Economy	32	5.5%	2.9
9	Crime & Public Safety	29	5.0%	12.2
10	Housing & Overdevelopment	29	5.0%	3.0

How the top issues moved over time

Monthly complaint counts for the five largest categories. Peaks follow a specific triggering event — a snowstorm, a violent incident, a budget vote — that pulls a burst of comment traffic onto the city's posts.

Read the flat early months with care. They reflect how much was sampled, not how much was said: Facebook coverage begins in November 2025, so months before that carry only the thinner Instagram slice. Compare against the sampling volume on the methodology page before reading any month-to-month movement as a real change in resident sentiment.



The complaints in residents' own words

Each category below shows its rank, volume, and a selection of verbatim comments. Quotes are reproduced as posted, including spelling and punctuation. Commenter names are omitted.

1

Snow, Flooding & Storm Response

149 complaints · 25.5% of all complaints · Facebook 117 · Instagram 32



"Yonkers is horrible, when it comes to parking and snow plowing. The fact that it has many many hills. Side streets are very dangerous. At least spread some salt on the steep hills, that are frozen solid. It's a gamble driving on side roads even two days after the storm."

Facebook · 2026 · on: "DPW crews have been focused primarily on the City's main roads throughout the day as the s..."

"DPW PLOWED 2 FEET OF COMPACT SNOW AND ICE ON TO MY CLEARED SIDE WALK YESTERDAY ! TELL YOUR DRIVERS TO SLOW DOWN ! !"

Facebook · 2026 · 1 likes · on: "Parks crews are tackling 34 sets of stairs, four miles of sidewalks, parking lots and comm..."

"Yonkers suck at plowing it will look worse then the last snow storm there will be no place to park on the side streets and can barely drive on them"

Instagram · 2026 · 1 likes · on: "■ ENFORCEMENT IN PROGRESS ■ The City is now ticketing and towing vehicles still parked on..."

"Real question is, Can you attach a plow on these bad boys, Other wise the ONLY FOOTPRINT i want to see on the Yonkers streets post snow storm is yours Spano, helping shovel snow."

Instagram · 2026 · on: "Meet "The Battle." Our newest all-electric garbage truck is now part of Yonkers' growing..."

2

City Responsiveness & Accountability

74 complaints · 12.7% of all complaints · Instagram 38 · Facebook 36



"The most corrupt city in New York State. How many members of the Spano Crime Family are profiting from the mayors control. Oh and I heard the mayor is already bribing the city council to give him another term since he can't find another job."

Instagram · 2026 · 1 likes · on: "This week in Yonkers: Potholes getting filled Cherry blossoms starting to bloom Dispatche..."

"I had the chance of meeting him and we discussed Yonkers as a whole, this was in 2012. He and I talk about changing Yonkers and honestly I thought this guy is all talk and he's just talking bull like most people in office. I feel like he has out did my perception of him, Mayor Spano your doing a fantastic job keep up the good work."

Facebook · 2026 · 1 likes · on: "Yonkers is continuing the transformation of the former Mulford Gardens site. The new Park..."

"@— that is correct. The whole council is corrupt too. Sneaky moves are happening behind closed doors - Spano and his council are horrible corrupt individuals."

Instagram · 2026 · on: "Did not expect the clock at Yonkers City Hall to look like this ■ Thanks to @mayormikesp..."

"I STG YOU BETTER NOT RUN FOR A FIFTH TERM!!!! PEOPLE ARE TIRED OF YOU AND YOUR FAKE CITY COUNCIL THAT JUST GOES WITH WHATEVER THE FXCK YOURE DOING!!!! ALL OF YOU ARE CORRUPT!!!! YONKERS NEEDS CHANGE!!!!!!"

Instagram · 2026 · 1 likes · on: "Yonkers, as we await the passage of New York State's Budget, this year's Executive Budget ..."

3

Parking

59 complaints · 10.1% of all complaints · Facebook 43 · Instagram 16



"How can alternate side be enforced when there is no where to park on many streets? Some areas, like mine, do not have access to alternate parking places."

Facebook · 2026 · 5 likes · on: "■ WEEKEND SNOW REMOVAL / NO PARKING NOTICE ■ Friday 1/30 – Sunday 2/1 ■■ Alternate side p..."

"Alternate side of street parking suspended!! But parking meters are in effect ?? How about clearing the metered spots !!"

Facebook · 2026 · 5 likes · on: "Parks crews are tackling 34 sets of stairs, four miles of sidewalks, parking lots and comm..."

"Tickets were given today to my entire street prob 20 cars and you guys did not announce anything in advance Last night i checked the website and it said that alternate parking is still suspended with no additional information All these tickets should be dismissed ppl literally have nowhere to park and you guys should communicate better Respectfully"

Facebook · 2026 · 5 likes · on: "■ WEEKEND SNOW REMOVAL / NO PARKING NOTICE ■ Friday 1/30 – Sunday 2/1 ■■ Alternate side p..."

"Suspending alternate side parking on Warburton means folks CAN park there. That means folks will remain parked on the east side of the street—the snow emergency route—where the snow needs to be removed. Instructions should say : No parking on the east side of Warburton remains in effect."

Facebook · 2026 · 3 likes · on: "DPW Snow Removal Update While crews continue plowing primary and secondary roads, additio..."

4

Taxes & Cost of Living

53 complaints · 9.1% of all complaints · Facebook 36 · Instagram 17



"We need lower property TAX, and better ROADS."

Facebook · 2026 · 14 likes · on: "BIG NEWS FOR DOWNTOWN YONKERS! ■ The City of Yonkers has been awarded \$10 million through..."

"Financial accountability. What does the city do with the funds they grab from tax payers? Cost of living is ridiculous in this city run by a someone who seems to have most of his family on the payroll"

Instagram · 2026 · 1 likes · on: "Yonkers, as we await the passage of New York State's Budget, this year's Executive Budget ..."

"Most new buildings have 5% affordable housing and ZERO PURCHASING POSSIBILITIES. There is no strong tax basis."

Facebook · 2026 · 2 likes · on: "Yonkers is leading the pack in creating more homes for New Yorkers. 3,000 new housing uni..."

"GET Rid of the tax when people sell their home to leave Yonkers. Start taxing landlords those w Illegal two families across the city that have illegal basement apartments! I can rattle a few pretty easy . Its across the entire city! Do the right thing you should NOT have to pay to leave its the most ridiculous thing"

Facebook · 2026 · on: "MOBILE TAX OFFICES RETURN TO YONKERS Pay your property taxes or water bills and get assis..."

5

Schools & Education

51 complaints · 8.7% of all complaints · Facebook 26 · Instagram 25



"GRADUATION RATE!!! Have you ever dealt with Yonkers Board of Education, the biggest pile of trash I've ever seen in my life! Biggest city in Westchester County with the worst school district ever! They don't care about these kids."

Instagram · 2026 · on: "Mayor Mike Spano (@mayormikespano) gives me the elevator pitch on the City of Yonkers and ..."

"Wait till tomorrow when school busses are getting stuck . My street was plowed once since Sunday cars have a hard time getting in and out. How is a school bus full of children getting through."

Facebook · 2026 · 7 likes · on: "■ Alternate Side Parking Update ■ ■ Wednesday (1/28) and Thursday (1/29) Alternate side s..."

"Please clean roads It took me an hour to drop my son off to school today, which normally take me 5 minutes. I was almost in to accidents 3 times and many school buses were stuck. It was a chaos around Pearls Hawthorne. My street was not even ploughed. It was too dangerous. Please clean roads....."

Facebook · 2026 · 2 likes · on: "■ Alternate Side Parking Update ■ ■ Wednesday (1/28) and Thursday (1/29) Alternate side s..."

"PLEASE CLEAN UP IN HOMEFIELD YONKERS. Every time I see a school bus turning and almost falling in Odel and Beverly is crazy. Not to mentioned they want the old residents to clean. What a shame"

Instagram · 2026 · on: "■ SNOW REMOVAL UPDATE | SATURDAY ■ City crews have worked day and night across Yonkers, f..."

6

Trash, Sanitation & Illegal Dumping

40 complaints · 6.8% of all complaints · Facebook 25 · Instagram 15



"Can we have a conversation about how filthy our streets are? Every road littered with trash, every exit ramp to any thruway, parkway or highway look worse than a garbage dump. Please do something."

Instagram · 2026 · 2 likes

"Today's recycle collection wasn't done on my block I assume because he couldn't turn due to the snow. Now what are we supposed to do, not have garbage pickup until the snow melts?"

Facebook · 2026 · on: "Quick reminder!..."

"When is Yonkers getting their own garbage and recycling cans to distribute to the residents of Yonkers? ■"

Facebook · 2026 · 1 likes · on: "Yonkers is continuing the transformation of the former Mulford Gardens site. The new Park..."

"Now if we could only get DPW to do there job and pickup all the garbage on the scheduled days instead of only picking up some of it!"

Facebook · 2026 · 2 likes · on: "Mayor's Clean Up ■■ Spring is here and it's time to clean things up. The Mayor's Clean Up..."

7

Roads & Potholes

36 complaints · 6.2% of all complaints · Facebook 23 · Instagram 13

"Fixing potholes? Try paving all streets instead of patching them for years. What a joke"

Instagram · 2026 · on: "Yonkers, I've heard your concerns. After a tough winter, our crews have already filled ov..."

"Maybe try fixing the potholes, the roads are dangerous."

Facebook · 2026 · 1 likes · on: "Yonkers is leading the pack in creating more homes for New Yorkers. 3,000 new housing uni..."

"The roads are horrible side streets even worse for such a big warning for this snow storm you'd think they'd be head of it...it's 5:06am Monday morning and the streets and side streets are just as they were when I went to sleep ■■■■■■■■■■■■"

Facebook · 2026 · 2 likes · on: "DPW crews have been focused primarily on the City's main roads throughout the day as the s..."

"FIX THE DAMNED POTHOLES..ALL OVER THE CITY, BEEN THERE SINCE LAST FALL.....WHY ARE YOU PAVING HUGE SWATHS OF ROADS THAT DON'T NEED PAVING... THEY COULD BE USED TO FILL MOST OF THE POTHOLES UP...."

Instagram · 2026 · on: "Downtown Yonkers is taking another major step forward. Thanks to Governor Kathy Hochul an..."

8

Jobs, Hiring & Local Economy

32 complaints · 5.5% of all complaints · Facebook 17 · Instagram 15

"Mike Spano you really are a POS! stop loathing the camera thinking your a star and do your job you mutt! Hire competent workers instead of DEI overpaid theft of services employees."

Facebook · 2026 · on: "Yonkers is now hiring Emergency Snow Shovelers to support ongoing winter cleanup across th..."

"Where are the jobs? I've been checking since they opened and have never seen them hiring"

Instagram · 2025 · on: "So excited to share the latest Hollywood on Hudson update with all of you! Yonkers isn't j..."

"An you Mr mayor have did a horrible job of giving these kids outlets but you built by the water pretty nice tho
■■■"

Facebook · 2026 · 16 likes · on: "Mayor Spano calls on lawmakers to address the root causes of gun violence following the fa..."

"Let's help kid our kids off the streets. We need summer programs jobs for teenagers.\nWhat's the money in that"

Facebook · 2026 · 11 likes · on: "Yonkers is leading the pack in creating more homes for New Yorkers. 3,000 new housing uni..."

9

Crime & Public Safety

29 complaints · 5.0% of all complaints · Facebook 16 · Instagram 13



"Stolen guns are null and void when it comes to law making at the federal level. Maybe the cash bail or halt policies made by the government in albany should be repealed to deter this type of violent crimes. Criminals aren't stupid. Just get a minor to do the violent crime and they're out on the street the next day."

Facebook · 2026 · 26 likes · on: "Mayor Spano calls on lawmakers to address the root causes of gun violence following the fa..."

"first it is not the gun like it is not the car who speeds and kills .. it is how these kids are being raised as well as how the parenting is .. the liberal light on crime policies.. the anti police attitude .. kids have no consequences to anything they do wrong .. the dumbing down of education they keep lowering the bar instead of raising the bar so kids have goals to achieve to better themselves"

Facebook · 2026 · 149 likes · on: "Mayor Spano calls on lawmakers to address the root causes of gun violence following the fa..."

"Ughhhh maybe if you stop letting criminals back out in the street after 5 mins of being arrested, it would make people think before committing crimes. There are. NO CONSEQUENCES so people just dont care. If it wasn't a gun, it'd be a knife, bat, car etc. The problem isn't guns, its the fact people can commit crimes and go on about their day like nothing happened"

Facebook · 2026 · 20 likes · on: "Mayor Spano calls on lawmakers to address the root causes of gun violence following the fa..."

"Stop blaming and let's work together for a solution. You know nothing about these kids. How do you know they come from broken homes? You blame the parents but how do you know thats the problem. There is a gang problem in Yonkers that is ignore. I have no solutions to why young kids are shooting each other on the streets. I just pray that it can be addressed and not forgotten."

Facebook · 2026 · 7 likes · on: "Mayor Spano calls on lawmakers to address the root causes of gun violence following the fa..."

10

Housing & Overdevelopment

29 complaints · 5.0% of all complaints · Facebook 16 · Instagram 13



"Hudson piers requires tenants to make 66 times the income for affordable housing. What a joke"

Facebook · 2026 · 1 likes · on: "Yonkers is leading the pack in creating more homes for New Yorkers. 3,000 new housing uni..."

"Is this the building that has been without heat for a year now- tenants are forced to cook with electric hobs. When Con Ed wanted the gas system replaced or would not pass the existing gas lines, without major modifications. Westchester Power should be able to give great rates, even though the landlord let the utilities fall into disrepair it seems"

Facebook · 2026 · 7 likes · on: "A major investment in Yonkers housing is underway. A \$35 million project at Palisade Tower..."

"Mayor stop lying when you have landlords of building raising rent and throwing out tenant because they refuse to pay a 42 % increase"

Facebook · 2026 · on: "Yonkers is leading the pack in creating more homes for New Yorkers. 3,000 new housing uni..."

"Hey so will we ever get true affordable housing? We gon make Yonkers more walkable? Why can't ya rezone central ave to allow housing. Maybe make those buses faster considering thousands of mostly working class ppl use them daily. This should not be a priority"

Instagram · 2026 · 16 likes · on: "Hey, Yonkers! Check out this new public EV charging station at 50 Warburton Avenue! It's t..."

Full category ranking

#	Category	Primary	Mentions	Share
1	Snow, Flooding & Storm Response	149	205	25.5%
2	City Responsiveness & Accountability	74	89	12.7%
3	Parking	59	72	10.1%
4	Taxes & Cost of Living	53	67	9.1%
5	Schools & Education	51	69	8.7%
6	Trash, Sanitation & Illegal Dumping	40	50	6.8%
7	Roads & Potholes	36	42	6.2%
8	Jobs, Hiring & Local Economy	32	53	5.5%
9	Crime & Public Safety	29	32	5.0%
10	Housing & Overdevelopment	29	37	5.0%
11	Homelessness & Quality of Life	12	16	2.1%
12	Street Lighting & Infrastructure	10	13	1.7%
13	Parks & Public Spaces	7	8	1.2%
14	Traffic, Speeding & Reckless Driving	3	7	0.5%

"Primary" counts comments whose dominant theme is that category. "Mentions" counts every comment that raises the issue at all, including alongside another complaint, so mentions exceed primary counts for issues that travel together.